



GOAL PLANNING SUCCESS WORKBOOK

Where Dreams Become Destinations



VALUES-DRIVEN CULTURE

Reflect Back

The first step to Goal Planning Success is to pause and reflect, to think about the previous year. This helps us to understand our recent past – like where did we spend our time? What worked? What didn't work? Please don't speed through this step. I have learned that taking time to reflect on my past helps me determine my goals for the future. 2 Corinthians 13:5, encourages us to examine and test ourselves, "Examine yourselves to see whether you are in the faith; test yourselves. Do you not realize that Christ Jesus is in you—unless, of course, you fail the test?"

Consider taking a long walk to "get in the zone" and deeply think about last year. Getting away from your daily commitments and distractions will help you focus on this task.

1. Where have I been?

Where am I now? (Did I accomplish all that I intended to do last year?)

2. More specifically:

- What did I accomplish? _____

- Where did I go? _____

- How did I feel? _____

- Who did I encounter? _____

- What did I learn? _____

Tip:

Flip back through the pages of your paper or electronic planner and calendar for the prior year. Then re-consider the questions above. Chances are this process will trigger a memory about the prior year that you want to record in the space above.

Next, rate your year in each area below by circling the number that reflects your candid assessment of how you did in each area. A rating of 1 is low, 5 is average, and 10 is high (as measured against your potential or opportunity):

1. Spiritual	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
2. Health/Physical well-being	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
3. Family/Spouse	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
4. Work Career	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
5. Personal Growth	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
6. Social/Friends/Community	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
7. Financial	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10

Dream Big

If we do not live and work toward our own dreams, we will wind up helping someone else live their dreams. As you work to discover and clarify your own dreams, ask yourself the following questions.

1. What will be my legacy? What do I dream to accomplish in life? _____

2. What do I dream to accomplish in the coming year? _____

a. What will it look like to accomplish these dreams?

b. How will I feel when I accomplish them?

c. Why are these dreams important to me?

3. What problems do I want to solve? _____

4. What opportunities do you want to pursue? _____

5. Where do I want to go? _____

6. Who do I want to become in the coming year? _____

“Who you are becoming is more important than what you are accumulating.

--Robin Sharma

Are you having difficulty identifying and describing your dreams? Your mindset may be holding you back.

People with a **scarcity** mindset find it hard to invest resources because they feel so *deficient*. They always feel (in an expedient way) that their commodities are about to *run out*. If you have a scarcity mindset, it will be difficult to escape the limitations of this way of thinking and discover your own dreams.

People with an **abundance** mindset believe that today's short-term pain, sacrifice, and investment in time, energy, and money, will eventually bring *long term growth, blessings and success*. As you adopt an abundance mindset, your dreams have a way of coming into focus. Ephesians 3:10 tells us, “**Now unto him that is able to do exceeding abundantly above all that we ask or think...**” May we start trusting in the giver of this abundance.

John C. Maxwell talks about the gap between two significant questions:

“Can I?” – A question by those who have a scarcity mindset. and

“How can I?” – A question by those who have an abundance mindset.

With this healthy, abundant mindset in mind, read back through the questions on the previous page and ask yourself, “How can I?”.

Plan & Write

For each of the main life areas listed below, ask yourself three questions and then write at least one goal for each area.

- A. Ask, **“What do I want to accomplish?”** Remember to structure what you write as specific, actionable, and realistic!
- a. *Specific* – Your goals must identify exactly what you want to accomplish.
 - b. *Action* – Your goals should lead to an action verb.
 - c. *Realistic* – Remember you are looking for progress not perfection. Your goals should be challenging and should stretch you. You should use common sense toward the results you want to achieve.
- B. And also ask **“How will I know it happened?”** This is all about measuring, for example: “I want to lose five pounds.”
- a. *Measurable* – You can’t manage what you can’t measure. Be specific of the results you desire.
 - b. *Celebrate* – You must know when you hit a goal so you can celebrate and reward yourself.
- C. Finally, ask **“How many weeks or months will it take for me to achieve this goal?”** This refers to the time required (like three months) to accomplish a given goal. For this exercise, let’s just think about the big picture amount of time required. Later in the process we will define concrete start and stops dates.

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1. Spiritual

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2. Health/Physical well-being

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3. Family/Spouse

☐

4. Work/Career

☐

5. Personal Growth

☐

6. Social/Friends/Community

☐

7. Financial

Research proves that you are 42% more likely to achieve your goals, simply by writing them down!¹

1. Dominican University of California: Goal Study: Dr. Gail Matthews PH.D.

Prioritize & Focus

When it comes to reaching our dreams, we need a way to get laser like focus, and direct it toward accomplishing our one top-priority goal. We can accomplish this by looking back at our list of goals from the previous section (Step 3 – Plan & Write) and asking some questions.

1. Ask yourself, “Which goal, when achieved will impact my life the most?”

2. Ask “Which goal, when accomplished, will make some of the other goals more achievable?”

3. Look back at your **Reflect Back** pages of the GPS workbook. Does your assessment of the last year highlight an area that may need your attention sooner rather than later?
Ask “Which goal represents an area that, if left unimproved, might threaten my dreams for the future?”

4. Ask “What goal will take the *least* amount of time to achieve?” Reaching this goal quickly could really create some momentum for you. Mark this goal with the letters “MO”, for **MO**mentum.

Now it is time to look at your list as a whole. How would you rank your goals in order of importance?

Which would be first?

May I suggest that you start with your goal marked “MO”, and make it your top priority? I have learned that if you experience early success in reaching your goals, you’ll be energized to start in on your next one.

Take time now to prioritize your goals on the **Plan & Write** workbook pages, marking a one by your top priority goal, a two by your next to top priority goal, and so on.

Write your top priority goal below – this is your Focus Goal, the one that you’ll devote your singular focus to, as you start your new year.

Focus Goal:

“Concentration is the secret of strength.

--Ralph Waldo Emerson

Act and Track

For our someday dream to become this year's destination, we need an action plan. This step (**Act & Track**) will empower you to transform your *Focus Goal* into a well-defined plan for weekly progress toward your final destination.

1. **Focus Goal** - Refer to your **Focus Goal** that you identified in the *Prioritize and Focus* step.

2. **Action Ideas** - It's important to break down your goal into *actions* that you can accomplish on a regular basis. Let's say your goal is to lose 10 pounds in the first quarter of the year, then you may want to consider what physical activity you could safely do on a regular basis to lose those 10 pounds.

The following list will help you put your ideas into an Action Plan:

3. **What** - Now determine how much of the action you will do in order to reach your Focus Goal. If it is exercise, you could name a distance or an amount of time. If you have a sales goal, it might be a certain number of prospecting calls per day.
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4. **When** - Next consider how many times a week you will perform your action. To continue with our example, maybe you decide to walk Monday, Wednesday, Friday and Saturday. Also determine what time of day you will commit to take action.
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5. **Where** - Think about where you will do your activity. In the case of our exercise example, ask yourself where you will walk. List the location of your goal action activity here:
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Action Plan Template

It is time to pull all your answers together into one clear Action Plan. Here is the format for an Action Plan:

During the next week I will (**fill in your activity here**) on (**day or days**) at (**time of day**) at/in (**place**).

Exercise example:

During the next week, I will walk three miles on Monday, Wednesday, Friday & Saturday at 7:00am in my neighborhood.

Sales example:

During the next week, I will make 10 prospecting calls on Monday, Wednesday, Friday at 8:30am at my office.

From your current **Focus Goal**, create an **Action Plan** by filling in the blanks below.

My Action Plan	
During the next week, I will _____	(type and amount of activity – “Action” & “Amount”)
on _____	(day or days of week – “Which days”)
at _____ at/in _____.	(time – When) (Where)

Post your Action Plan in a prominent place where you will see it daily.

Track

Lastly, you’ll want to track your progress toward your final destination. This might involve weighing yourself weekly to monitor your weight loss, or tallying the actual number of prospecting calls you make each week. Tracking your progress allows you to:

- 1) Acknowledge small wins on your way to the final goal, and
- 2) Make any necessary adjustments to your goal if you discover the need to refine it